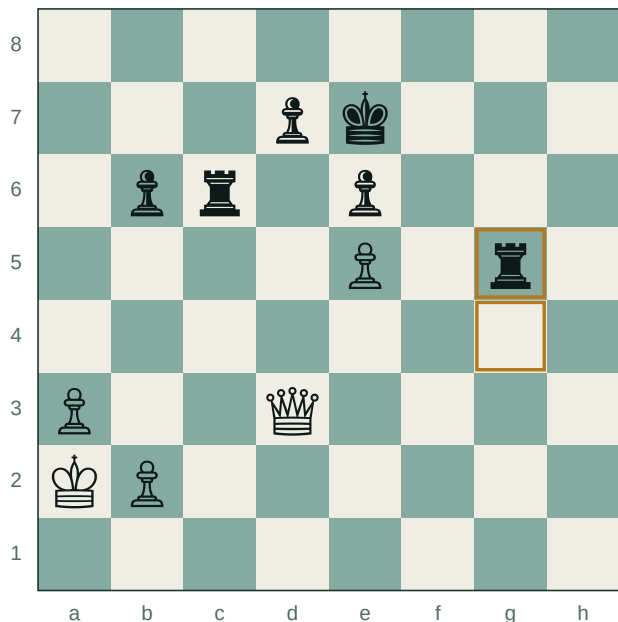


# Queen-and-rook endings: White, move 46

Queen-and-rook endings

White to move



Previous move: 45...Rg5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**46. Qh7+ Kd8 47. Qh4 Kc7 48. Qxg5**

**46.Qh7+** Check restricts Black to 4 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **46...Kd8**.

**47.Qh4** The queen moves from h7 to h4. Recorded reply: **47...Kc7**.

**48.Qxg5** The queen captures the rook on g5.

At the end, nominal material is White 12 / Black 8 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

**CHECKPOINT**

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +5: the balance goes from -1 to +4. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

**CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES**

Do not activate the king as casually as in a pure pawn ending. The remaining heavy pieces can still generate a mating net.

**WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES**

When queens and rooks remain, mating threats coexist with endgame pawn races. Coordination and king shelter remain essential even on a sparse board.

**HOW TO LOOK**

Look for heavy-piece batteries, skewers, and checks that force a defender away from a promotion square or pawn.

The defending king is on e7. Geometrically undefended: rook on g5. Check for tactical protection.